4.2 Command your sprite

In this lesson

You will learn:

➔ how to add commands to your program.

Load program file

Last lesson you saved your work as a file. Now you will load the file. Load means get a file from storage.



Open the file menu. Click on 'load from your computer'. Choose the file you made last time.

Coloured dots and blocks

You will make a Scratch program. A program is made of **commands**. Commands tell the computer what to do.

Scratch commands are blocks. You fit the blocks together. That makes the program.

Different types of blocks are different colours.

- 'Motion' blocks are blue.
- 'Sound' blocks are pink.

Look for the coloured dots on the left of the screen. Choose a colour to help you pick the blocks you need.

Actions

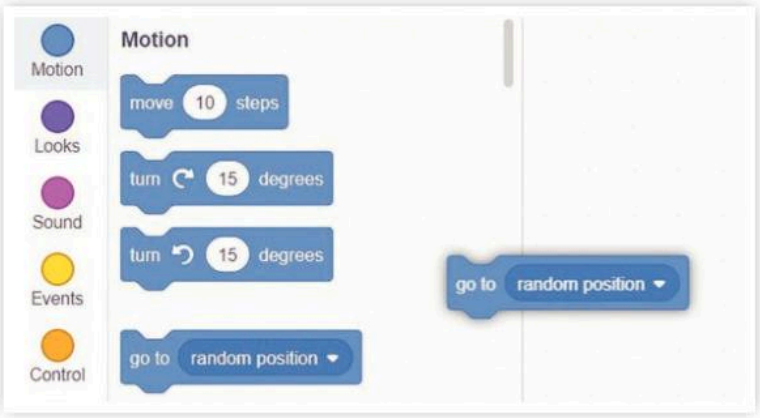
Choose a block. It will make your sprite move.

Click on the blue dot. You will see 'Motion' blocks.

Find the block that says 'go to random position'.

Drag this block to the middle of the screen.

Click on the block. The sprite will move.



Sounds

Choose a block. It will play a sound. Click on the pink dot. You will see 'Sound' blocks. Choose the 'play sound' block.

Now you have two blocks. Fit the blocks together.

Click on the two blocks. What happens?





Activity

Make the two-block program shown on this page.



Extra challenge

Add any other block to the program. See what happens when you run the program.

Think again

Say what blocks you used. Say what each block did.

4.3 A start event

In this lesson

You will learn:

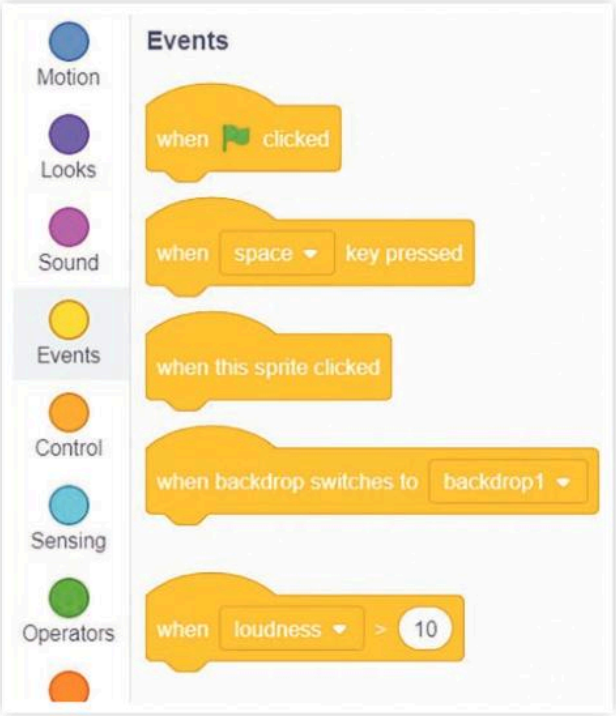
- to choose an event that starts the program.

Events

An **event** means anything that happens. In Scratch 'Events' are things the **user** does. The user is the person who uses the program. Now you will choose the 'Event' that lets the user start your program.

Click on the yellow dot that says 'Events'.

What 'Event' blocks can you see? What does each one say?

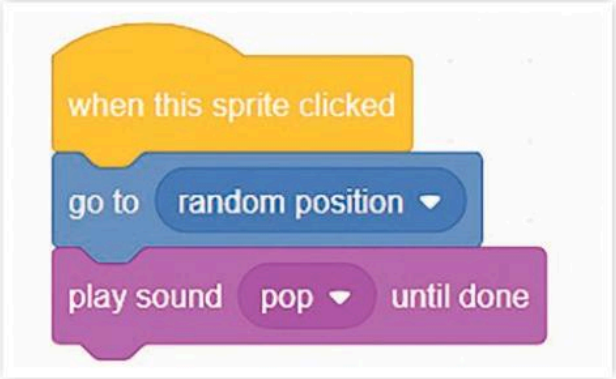


Choose an event

To choose an 'Event' drag the block to the program area.

Find the 'Event' block that says 'when this sprite clicked'.

Fit the program blocks onto the 'Event' block. Now the event will start the program.



Change colour

Now you will make the sprite change colour. Click on the purple dot that says 'Looks'. These command blocks change the look of the sprite.

Find the block that says 'change color effect by…'.

Drag this block to the script area and add it to the program.





Activity

Change your program.

- Add the 'Event' block which says 'when this sprite clicked'.
- Add the 'Looks' block which changes the colour of the sprite.

Click the sprite to make it move.

Save the file.



Extra challenge

Choose a different start event. Change the program to the new event.

Think again

Draw the 'Event' block you used. Say what it does.

If you used more than one, draw them all.